

# Shavelly Then

Director, Digital Strategy & User Experience · Information Architecture

[shavellythen.github.io/portfolio](https://shavellythen.github.io/portfolio)

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## PROFILE

I focus on the often unseen but essential side of digital experience the information architecture, taxonomy, and content structure that help people find what they need quickly and intuitively. At the University of Miami, I've improved site health from 48 to 89, contributed to the information architecture supporting the \$2.5B *Everbrighter Campaign*, and am currently leading the consolidation of four web properties for the School of Law. Backed by a master's degree in Experience and Information Design and nearly a decade of hands-on experience, I've had the opportunity to build and refine these practices across both Development & Alumni Relations and the School of Law. That experience has given me a strong understanding of the institution, established relationships across teams, and the ability to navigate complex digital ecosystems while delivering thoughtful, user-centered solutions.

## EDUCATION

### M.S. in Experience and Information Design (XiD)

2026

University of Miami — GPA 3.8

Centered on information architecture and digital design.

### Google UX Design Specialization

2024

Google

### Meta Front-End Developer Specialization

2024

Meta

### B.S. in Graphic Communications

2018

Dallas Baptist University — GPA 3.8, Magna Cum Laude

## EXPERIENCE

### Director, Digital Strategy and User Experience — University of Miami, School of Law

2024 – Present

- Leading a phased consolidation of four Law web properties (student, alumni, admissions, and Heckerling Institute) onto a single domain: built the content inventory, complexity and effort assessment, and migration sequencing roadmap to preserve SEO authority and support accurate answer-engine (AEO) citation. Previously led the same type of migration for the university's alumni ecosystem, restructuring a single alumni-only site into the Development and Alumni Association property.
- Own information architecture and technical health governance across Miami Law's digital properties: drove admissions.law.miami.edu from an Ahrefs Health Score of 77 to a perfect 100 (errors reduced from 235 to 5), and law.miami.edu from 48 to 89 (an 85% improvement, errors down 82% from 2,957 to 520).
- Led a full content and IA revamp of the LL.M. program pages — restructuring navigation and content models across 16 pages — driving +219% sessions, +264% key events, and a 74% engagement rate (GA4 / Looker Studio).
- Implemented and tested FAQ schema markup via Google Tag Manager on graduate program pages (including the M.L.S.), supporting structured data and answer-engine visibility.
- Evaluate and recommend third-party tool subscriptions (e.g., Ahrefs, Elfsight) based on pricing and feature comparison, informing purchasing decisions for the digital team.
- Launched a monthly Web Office Hours program establishing consistent content, SEO, and accessibility standards across Law School web editors; direct the work of student designers, interns, and outside vendors, and monitor properties for WCAG/ADA compliance.

### Senior Graphic Designer — University of Miami, Development & Alumni Relations

2022 – 2024

- Built and maintained reusable Enewsletter design templates in Salesforce and a shared design archive that eliminated redundant work and supported cross-training across the team.
- Designed interfaces and page structures for university websites, and apps, translating stakeholder goals into wireframes, prototypes, and reusable component-based design systems.

### Manager — University of Miami, Development & Alumni Relations

2018 – 2022

- Restructured a single, one-size-fits-all alumni site into a persona-driven information architecture with 4 distinct audience journeys (Alumni, Friends, Parents, Students) and an 8-category primary navigation. Rebuilt page templates, CTAs, and URL structure in Cascade Server (Hannon Hill) to serve each audience's needs individually.
- Grew the alumni news site's pageviews 57% and unique pageviews 58%, lifted average time on site 12%, and raised organic search ranking 23% through site structure and content improvements.

- Served as UX researcher on the university's Ever Brighter capital campaign website: led stakeholder interviews and competitive benchmarking, then organized site information architecture around three donor-interest content themes for a campaign that raised \$2.5B.
- Built a microsite for 'Cane Biz and a monthly event-digest template that cut ad hoc event email volume; rolled out the Localist event platform across university sites and the Alumni App for personalized event feeds.
- Owned site information architecture and URL structure across Cascade Server (Hannon Hill); ran A/B-tested email campaigns lifting open rates up to 18% and click-through rates up to 18%.

**Graphic Web Designer** — *Dallas Baptist University, Communications*

2017 – 2018

- Produced marketing and web graphics and led design/production of print collateral including brochures, flyers, and posters.

**Web Designer** — *Kairos Design Studio*

2016 – 2017

- Designed digital platform interfaces and implemented design systems to maintain brand consistency.

## SKILLS

**INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE** Site Taxonomy, Sitemaps, Card Sorting & Tree Testing, URL Structure & Redirect Strategy, Content Modeling, Navigation Design, Governance Documentation

**USER RESEARCH** UserTesting/UserZoom, Microsoft Clarity, Google Forms, Qualtrics, Usability Testing

**SEO / AEO & ANALYTICS** Google Analytics, Google Search Console, Structured Data/Schema Markup (FAQ Schema, GTM), Screaming Frog, SEMrush, Google Tag Manager, Looker Studio, Ahrefs

**CMS & CONTENT OPS** Cascade CMS (Hannon Hill), Drupal, WordPress, SharePoint

**PROJECT & WORKFLOW MANAGEMENT** Asana, Jira, Monday.com, FigJam

**ACCESSIBILITY** WCAG / ADA Compliance Auditing

**UX/UI DESIGN** Wireframing & Prototyping, Interaction & Visual Design, Responsive Design, Figma, Sketch, Adobe Creative Suite

**TECHNICAL & MARKETING** HTML/CSS, A/B Testing, Salesforce, Email Marketing Platforms

**LEADERSHIP** Team Direction & Delegation, Vendor Management, Cross-Functional Collaboration

## AWARDS

**Outstanding Graduate Student Award** — University of Miami, School of Communication

**Web Enhancements Award** — CASE Award, 2022